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shell scripting type of language

Shell scripting is an **interpreted, domain-specific command language** used primarily for automation, system administration, and program orchestration. Instead of being compiled into machine code like C++ or Java, it is read and executed line-by-line by a command-line interpreter known as a "shell". Wikipedia +3

Key Characteristics

- Interpreted Execution:** Code runs directly from plain-text files without requiring a compilation phase. ScienceDirect.com +1
- Command Orchestration:** It acts as a wrapper to seamlessly connect, manipulate, and stream data between different standalone applications and system utilities. Wikipedia +1
- Weakly and Dynamically Typed:** Variables generally do not need explicit type declarations (like `int` or `string`) and are often treated as text strings by default until evaluated in arithmetic contexts. Medium · Covenant Chukw...

Common Shell Scripting Dialects

Shell Language	Description
Bash (Bourne Again Shell)	The industry standard and default shell for most Linux distributions and macOS terminal environments.
sh (Bourne Shell)	The original Unix shell; highly portable and serves as the baseline standard for POSIX-compliant scripting.

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other command languages

Other command languages include **Windows PowerShell, command-line interfaces (CLI) for specific software environments, job control languages, and automation-focused scripting tools**. While shell languages are tightly coupled to operating system kernels, command languages encompass a broader category of languages designed to issue directives,



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- **Mainframe Job Control: JCL (Job Control Language)** is used on IBM mainframe operating systems to instruct the system on how to run a batch job or request system resources. [↗](#)
- **Database Control Languages: [SQL \(Structured Query Language\)](#)** includes sub-languages like **DCL (Data Control Language)**, which uses command directives such as `GRANT` and `REVOKE` to control user access privileges. [↗](#)
- **Interactive Design and CAD: AutoLISP** and the native command-line language in AutoCAD allow engineers to type precise, text-based geometric coordinates and drafting commands to build blueprints. [↗](#)
- **Network Equipment Configuration: Cisco IOS CLI** uses a proprietary command language specifically designed to configure routers, switches, and network security appliances.

To help narrow this down, let me know if you are looking for a language to manage a **specific operating system**, orchestrate a **particular software program**, or handle **mainframe applications**. I can provide syntax examples for that system.





Other major job and system control languages include **IBM's CL (Control Language), EXEC 8 / ECL for Unisys mainframes, and OS/390 TSO/E CLIST**. These languages are designed specifically to initialize system environments, allocate hardware resources, and orchestrate the execution of compiled programs on enterprise server architectures. [↗](#)

- **IBM CL (Control Language):** The primary command and scripting language for the **IBM i (formerly OS/400)** platform. It is highly structured, using standardized parameters to perform system administration, compile programs, control job queues, and handle system security.
- **Unisys ECL / EXEC 8 (Executive Control Language):** Used on Unisys ClearPath Forward and legacy Sperry Univac mainframes running the [OS 2200 operating system](#). Similar to JCL, it uses commands prefixed with an "@" symbol (e.g., @RUN , @ASSIGN) to manage batch job processing.
- **CLIST (Command List) & REXX:** Native command procedures used within **IBM's TSO/E (Time Sharing Option/Extensions)** on z/OS. They act as higher-level, interactive alternatives to standard JCL, allowing administrators to allocate datasets and automate routine terminal operations.
- **VMS DCL (DIGITAL Command Language):** The standard command line and scripting interface for [OpenVMS operating systems](#) (originally built by DEC, now maintained by VMS Software). It uses a clean, English-like syntax to manage files, system logicals, and process controls.



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IBM z/OS Mainframe	JCL	Allocates a dataset and runs a program	<pre>//STEP1 EXEC PGM=MYPROG //DD1 DD DSN=MY.DATA,DISP=SHR</pre>
IBM i (OS/400)	CL	Sends a system message to a user	<pre>SNDMSG MSG(' Job Completed') TOUSR(ADMIN)</pre>
OpenVMS	DCL	Assigns a logical name to a device	<pre>ASSIGN SYS\$DISK: [USER.DIR] MY_DIR</pre>
Unisys OS 2200	ECL	Assigns a physical file to a job	<pre>@ASG,A MYFILE.</pre>

If you are working on modernizing a specific architecture, let me know if you are targetting a **particular mainframe OS** or looking to translate legacy code into an **automated pipeline tool (like Ansible or Python)**. I can map out how those old commands translate to modern system tools. [🔗](#)



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